KCE PATHWAYS · GRADE 3 · UNIT 6: BUILDING TOGETHER · WEEK 27 · READING

# The Front-Page Choice — Teacher Lesson Plan & Answer Key

**Learning objectives:** Students identify the four parts of an opinion piece (opinion, reasons, examples, conclusion), tell strong reasons and examples from feelings and off-topic sentences, use the linking words because, for example, also and therefore (with a comma after a linking word that starts a sentence), judge which piece supports its opinion better, and revise a weak opinion piece.

**Duration:** 35–45 minutes
**Materials:** Computer or tablet with the lesson open · pencil · printed Pre & Post sheet

## Lesson flow (as it appears on screen)

1. Title and name: the student types first and last name so results go to KingCretot Experience. Read the Pathway Points rules together: 2 tries per question, points only for a correct first try, and the answer and reason appear after a second miss. Introduce the Mountain Kids Gazette, a newspaper written by kids at a community center in Asheville, North Carolina, where the editor Ms. Fonda and the kid editors Forrest and Fiona must choose one field trip opinion piece for the front page.
2. Warm-Up, Part 1: Week 26 Review (6 pts, 3 each): retelling a fable from Aesop (The Lion and the Mouse, The Ant and the Grasshopper, or The Tortoise and the Hare, a different fable in each set).
3. Warm-Up, Part 2 (6 pts, 3 each): the central message of the same fable, plus a find-the-mistake or which-explanation item.
4. Pencil Break (Pre): the student opens or prints the Pre/Post sheet (grade3/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G3W27.pdf) and completes Page 1 (Pre) before any teaching. Do not help with answers; it shows what they already know.
5. Word Wrangler: 6 vocabulary cards (opinion, reason, example, conclusion, support, editor), each with a sentence from the newspaper.
6. Picture It: The Opinion Sandwich. The opinion is the top bun, reasons and examples are the fillings, the conclusion is the bottom bun, and linking words are the toothpicks. Ask: what does the writer think? Why? How do I know?
7. Read: The Mountain Kids Gazette (Fidel's Go Wild at the Nature Center!, about the Western North Carolina Nature Center; Fiorella's The Arboretum, about the North Carolina Arboretum; and Ms. Fonda's tips). Have the student point to the opinion, a reason, an example and each linking word.
8. The Parts of an Opinion Piece, Part 1 (6 pts, 3 each): finding Fidel's opinion ("I think" is a clue), how many reasons he gives, the conclusion, and what Fiorella's piece is missing.
9. The Parts of an Opinion Piece, Part 2 (3 pts): the conclusion is not extra, an opinion can be supported well or poorly but not proven, and facts can be examples.
10. Strong Reasons and Examples, Part 1 (6 pts, 3 each): a reason tells WHY; an example PROVES it (only 14 red wolves were found to start a program, and now there are more than 300). Feelings like "It is really nice" are not reasons.
11. Strong Reasons and Examples, Part 2 (3 pts): the off-topic sentence (my cousin got a new red bike) and why a feeling is weak support.

12. Linking Words, Part 1 (6 pts, 3 each): because comes before a reason, for example before an example, also adds one more idea, therefore comes before a result or conclusion.
13. Linking Words, Part 2 (3 pts): for example must come before an example, choosing because, and why because and therefore cannot swap places.
14. Judge It, Then Write It, Part 1 (6 pts, 3 each): which piece has better support (Fidel's), how many linking words Fiorella uses (none), and revising her piece: a new first sentence, also, and cutting the off-topic sentence.
15. Judge It, Then Write It, Part 2 (3 pts): an opinion is not right or wrong, the best conclusion for Fiorella, and why any place can have a strong piece with good support.
16. Word Work Bonus, Part 1: Homophones (XP only, not scored).
17. Word Work Bonus, Part 2: Homophones (XP only, not scored).
18. Match-Up Round (10 pts, 2 per first-try match): Set 1 matches opinion words to meanings, Set 2 matches linking words to their jobs, Set 3 matches newspaper details to what they tell about.
19. Fix the Sentence (10 pts, 5 each): each item names the one kind of fix (capital letters for names, a city and a state or a place, the comma after a starting linking word, list commas, or one verb). The whole sentence is checked exactly; curly quotes and extra spaces are forgiven. The corrected sentence appears after the 2nd miss.
20. Type-It Corral, Part 1 (8 pts, 4 each): typed vocabulary and text-detail answers; capital letters and a final period do not matter, but spelling does. The "Look back" panel is allowed.
21. Type-It Corral, Part 2 (4 pts): one more typed answer, a two-step word problem, same checking rules.
22. Speed Arena, Part 1 (XP only, not scored).
23. Speed Arena, Part 2 and Keyboard Corral (XP only, not scored).
24. Boss Battle, Part 1: Front-Page Showdown (10 pts, 5 each): the two linking words that start Fidel's first two reasons, a stronger reason for Fiorella, which piece goes on the front page and why, and typed details and a two-step problem.
25. Boss Battle, Part 2: Front-Page Showdown (10 pts, 5 each): find-the-mistake items (the red wolf numbers are facts; a piece cannot start with Also), what Fidel's Also paragraph does, and typed words (wild, therefore, comma).
26. Pencil Break (Post): the student turns to Page 2 (Post) of the same sheet (grade3/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G3W27.pdf) and completes it, plus the ★ Challenge if time allows, before seeing the score. The sheet buttons let the student open or print it again.
27. Results (Front-Page Writer!): the score out of 100 is sent to KingCretot Experience. 85 or higher shows "Opinion Writing Master!" with the congratulations message "Opinion writing master!" and a big confetti burst; below 85 shows "Great Effort Today!" with encouragement ("Every great writer revises. You can too!"), and the next attempt brings a fresh question set (sets rotate 1, 2, 3). Both messages remind the student to finish the Post-Lesson Challenge sheet.

## Lesson answer key with reasoning

*Every scored item the student sees, in order, across all three rotating question sets. Each item allows 2 tries and earns Pathway Points only on a correct first try. The "why" is the same reasoning shown on screen after a second missed try.*

### WARM-UP: WEEK 26 REVIEW (3 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| w1_s0 | Set 1:<br>*The Lion and the Mouse · a fable from Aesop, ancient Greece A lion caught a tiny mouse. "Please let me go," squeaked the mouse. "Someday I will help you." The lion laughed, but he let her go. Later, hunters caught the lion in a rope net. The mouse heard him roar. She chewed through the ropes, and the lion was free.*<br>Which is the best BEGINNING for a retelling of this fable? [A lion caught a tiny mouse, and she promised to help him someday. / The lion was free. / The mouse chewed through the ropes. / Hunters are good at making nets.] | **A lion caught a tiny mouse, and she promised to help him someday.** | The beginning tells who is in the story and how it starts. The ropes and the freedom come at the end. |
| w2_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: At the end, the mouse chewed through the ___. | **ropes** (also accepted: the ropes, net, the net, rope net, the rope net) | She chewed through the ropes of the hunters' net, and the lion was free. |
| w3_s0 | Set 1: What is the central message of the fable? [Even a small friend can be a big help, so be kind to everyone. / Lions are stronger than mice. / Never go near a net. / Mice like to chew ropes.] | **Even a small friend can be a big help, so be kind to everyone.** | The lion laughed at the idea that a tiny mouse could help him. Then she saved him. The lesson is about kindness to everyone. |
| w4_s0 | Set 1: Find the mistake! Foster says, "The central message is: a lion and a mouse." What went wrong? [That names the characters. A central message is a lesson written as a full sentence. / There is no mouse in the fable. / Fables have no message. / Nothing went wrong.] | **That names the characters. A central message is a lesson written as a full sentence.** | Remember from Week 26: a topic or a list of characters is not a lesson. |
| w1_s1 | Set 2:<br>*The Ant and the Grasshopper · a fable from Aesop, ancient Greece All summer, the ant carried seeds to her nest. The grasshopper sang in the sun. "Why work so hard?" he asked. When winter came, snow covered the fields. The ant had plenty of food, but the grasshopper had none. He wished he had saved food in the summer.*<br>Type your answer: In the summer, the grasshopper ___ in the sun. | **sang** | The fable says the ant carried seeds while the grasshopper sang in the sun. |
| w2_s1 | Set 2: Which retelling keeps the events in the right order? [The ant worked all summer. Then winter came. The grasshopper had no food. / Winter came. The ant worked all summer. The grasshopper sang. / The grasshopper had no food. Then summer came. / The ant had no food, so the grasshopper shared.] | **The ant worked all summer. Then winter came. The grasshopper had no food.** | Summer comes first, then winter. The last choice also changes what happens, which a retelling must never do. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| w3_s1 | Set 2: What is the central message of The Ant and the Grasshopper? [It is wise to prepare today for what you will need later. / Singing is bad. / Ants are bigger than grasshoppers. / Snow is cold.] | **It is wise to prepare today for what you will need later.** | The ant saved food for winter, and the grasshopper did not. He wished he had prepared. |
| w4_s1 | Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Fiona says, "The grasshopper learns from a mistake, like Anansi did." Foster says, "The grasshopper is a hero who shares, like Momotarō." [Fiona is right, because the grasshopper, like Anansi, learns a lesson the hard way / Foster is right, because the grasshopper shares his food / Foster is right, because the grasshopper beats the ogres / Neither is right, because the grasshopper learns nothing] | **Fiona is right, because the grasshopper, like Anansi, learns a lesson the hard way** | The grasshopper wished he had saved food. Like Anansi, he learned from his own mistake. |
| w1_s2 | Set 3:<br>*The Tortoise and the Hare · a fable from Aesop, ancient Greece The hare laughed at the slow tortoise, so the tortoise said, "Let's race!" The hare zoomed ahead. He was so far in front that he lay down for a nap. The tortoise kept walking, step by step. When the hare woke up, the tortoise was crossing the finish line!*<br>Why did the hare lie down for a nap? [He was so far in front that he thought he could not lose. / He was hurt. / The tortoise told him to. / It was nighttime.] | **He was so far in front that he thought he could not lose.** | The fable says he was so far in front that he lay down for a nap. |
| w2_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: Who won the race? | **tortoise** (also accepted: the tortoise) | When the hare woke up, the tortoise was crossing the finish line. |
| w3_s2 | Set 3: Find the mistake! Fiona retells: "The hare zoomed ahead and won the race, because he was so fast." What went wrong? [She changed the ending. In the fable, the tortoise wins. / She used her own words. / The hare never ran. / Nothing went wrong.] | **She changed the ending. In the fable, the tortoise wins.** | A retelling may use your own words, but it must never change what happens. |
| w4_s2 | Set 3: What is the central message of The Tortoise and the Hare? [Steady effort can beat speed, so keep going and do not give up. / Hares are lazy animals. / Races are always fun. / Naps are bad for you.] | **Steady effort can beat speed, so keep going and do not give up.** | The slow tortoise kept walking step by step, and he won. One animal does not stand for all hares! |

## THE PARTS OF AN OPINION PIECE (3 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| t1a_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: The sentence that tells what the writer thinks is called the ___. | **opinion** (also accepted: the opinion, opinion statement) | The opinion tells what the writer thinks. It often starts with I think. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| t1b_s0 | Set 1: Which sentence is Fidel's OPINION? [I think our class should take its spring field trip to the Western North Carolina Nature Center. / The Nature Center has black bears, river otters, and red wolves. / Red wolves almost disappeared. / We would have more time to explore.] | **I think our class should take its spring field trip to the Western North Carolina Nature Center.** | Fidel's opinion is what he thinks: the class should go to the Nature Center. The other sentences support it. |
| t1c_s0 | Set 1: Find the mistake! Foster says, "Fidel's last paragraph is just extra. You could take it out." What went wrong? [The last paragraph is the conclusion. It says the opinion again and ends the piece. / Fidel has no last paragraph. / The last paragraph is a new opinion. / Nothing went wrong.] | **The last paragraph is the conclusion. It says the opinion again and ends the piece.** | Without a conclusion, an opinion piece just stops. Therefore tells the reader the conclusion is here. |
| t1a_s1 | Set 2: Which part of an opinion piece tells WHY the writer thinks so? [The reasons / The title / The writer's age / The name of the newspaper] | **The reasons** | Reasons tell why. Fidel says, "I have three reasons." |
| t1b_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: Fidel writes, "I have ___ reasons." (Type the number.) | **three** (also accepted: 3) | Fidel's first paragraph says, "I have three reasons." |
| t1c_s1 | Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Fiona says, "An opinion cannot be proven true or false, but it can be supported with reasons and examples." Foster says, "An opinion piece is only good if everyone agrees with it." [Fiona is right, because readers judge how well an opinion is supported / Foster is right, because everyone must agree / Foster is right, because opinions are facts / Neither is right, because opinions need no support] | **Fiona is right, because readers judge how well an opinion is supported** | Ms. Fonda says an opinion is not right or wrong, but some pieces support their opinion much better than others. |
| t1a_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: The ending that says the writer's opinion again is the ___. | **conclusion** (also accepted: the conclusion) | The conclusion comes last and says the opinion again in a new way. |
| t1b_s2 | Set 3: Which part is MOST missing from Fiorella's piece? [Reasons that tell why, with examples that prove them / An opinion / A title / A writer's name] | **Reasons that tell why, with examples that prove them** | Fiorella has an opinion, "The Arboretum is the best," but "It is really fun" and "I like it a lot" are feelings, not reasons with proof. |
| t1c_s2 | Set 3: Find the mistake! Fiona says, "Fidel's piece has no opinion, because it has facts in it." What went wrong? [An opinion piece can use facts as examples. Fidel's opinion is in his first sentence. / Fidel's piece has no facts. / Opinion pieces may never have facts. / Nothing went wrong.] | **An opinion piece can use facts as examples. Fidel's opinion is in his first sentence.** | Facts like the red wolf numbers are examples. They support Fidel's opinion. |

## STRONG REASONS AND EXAMPLES (3 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| t2a_s0 | Set 1: Which is one of Fidel's REASONS? [We can see animals that live in our own mountains. / Let's go wild! / I have three reasons. / My cousin got a new red bike.] | **We can see animals that live in our own mountains.** | A reason tells why. Fidel's first reason is that we can see animals that live in our own mountains. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| t2b_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: Fidel's example: the Nature Center has black bears, river otters, and red ___. | **wolves** | Fidel writes, "For example, the Nature Center has black bears, river otters, and red wolves." |
| t2c_s0 | Set 1: Which sentence from Fiorella's piece is the WEAKEST support, because it is off topic? [My cousin got a new red bike. / The Arboretum is the best. / Everyone should go there. / It is the best place ever.] | **My cousin got a new red bike.** | A cousin's bike has nothing to do with a field trip to the Arboretum. Off-topic sentences should be cut. |
| t2a_s1 | Set 2: Which example supports Fidel's reason "We can learn how people help animals"? [Only 14 red wolves were found to start a program, and now there are more than 300. / The bus ride would be short. / Most of us have never seen these animals. / Let's go wild!] | **Only 14 red wolves were found to start a program, and now there are more than 300.** | The red wolf numbers show how people helped animals. That proves his second reason. |
| t2b_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: Two steps: Suppose a red wolf program started with 14 wolves and now has 314. How many more red wolves is that? (Type the number.) | **300** (also accepted: three hundred) | Subtract: 314 minus 14 equals 300 more red wolves. |
| t2c_s1 | Set 2: Find the mistake! Foster says, "It is really nice is a strong reason, because it is short." What went wrong? [It is really nice is a feeling. It does not tell WHY, and it has no example. / It is really nice is a fact. / Short reasons are always strong. / Nothing went wrong.] | **It is really nice is a feeling. It does not tell WHY, and it has no example.** | A strong reason tells why and can be proven with an example. Being short does not make a reason strong. |
| t2a_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: A ___ tells WHY. An example shows or proves it. | **reason** (also accepted: a reason) | A reason tells why the writer thinks something. An example proves it. |
| t2b_s2 | Set 3: Which is a FACT that could support Fiorella's opinion? [The Arboretum has a bonsai collection of tiny trees growing in pots. / It is the best place ever. / I like it a lot. / It is really nice.] | **The Arboretum has a bonsai collection of tiny trees growing in pots.** | A bonsai collection is a real feature of the North Carolina Arboretum, and a reader can check it. The others are feelings. |
| t2c_s2 | Set 3: Which explanation is correct? Fiona says, "I like it a lot is weak, because it only tells a feeling and gives readers no reason to agree." Foster says, "I like it a lot is strong, because feelings are always the best reasons." [Fiona is right, because a reader needs a reason and an example, not only a feeling / Foster is right, because feelings prove opinions / Foster is right, because every feeling is a fact / Neither is right, because opinion pieces need no reasons] | **Fiona is right, because a reader needs a reason and an example, not only a feeling** | Ms. Fonda says: "I like it" is a feeling, not a reason! |

## LINKING WORDS (3 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| t3a_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: Fidel writes, "___ nature centers and zoos worked to help them, there are now more than 300." Type the missing linking word. | **because** | Because comes before the reason: nature centers and zoos worked to help. |
| t3b_s0 | Set 1: Which linking word ADDS one more idea? [also / because / therefore / for example] | **also** | Also adds another idea. Fidel uses it to add his third reason. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| t3c_s0 | Set 1: Find the mistake! Foster writes: “The Arboretum has trails. For example, I think we should go.” What went wrong? [For example must come before an example. I think we should go is an opinion, not an example. / He needs the word also. / Trails are not real. / Nothing went wrong.] | **For example must come before an example. I think we should go is an opinion, not an example.** | An example would be: “For example, the Arboretum has hiking and bicycling trails.” |
| t3a_s1 | Set 2: Fidel’s last paragraph begins with Therefore. What does therefore tell the reader? [The reasons lead to a result: the conclusion is coming. / An example is coming. / One more reason is coming. / The piece is starting.] | **The reasons lead to a result: the conclusion is coming.** | Therefore means “so, as a result.” It signals the conclusion. |
| t3b_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: Type the linking word that fits: “The Arboretum has many trails. ___, it has a garden railway with model trains.” | **also** | The second sentence adds one more idea, so the linking word is Also. |
| t3c_s1 | Set 2: Choose the linking word: “Bring a water bottle on the trip, ___ the trails can be long.” [because / for example / therefore / first] | **because** | The trails can be long is the REASON to bring water, so use because. |
| t3a_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: Which two-word linking phrase comes right before an example? (Type both words.) | **for example** | For example comes before a fact or detail that proves a reason. |
| t3b_s2 | Set 3: Choose the linking word: “The bus ride would be short. ___, we would have more time to explore.” [Therefore, / For example, / Because / First,] | **Therefore,** | More time to explore is a RESULT of the short bus ride, so use Therefore. |
| t3c_s2 | Set 3: Which explanation is correct? Fiona says, “Because comes before a reason, and therefore comes before a result.” Foster says, “Because and therefore mean the same thing, so they can swap places in any sentence.” [Fiona is right, because the two words point in opposite directions / Foster is right, because they are both linking words / Foster is right, because they have the same letters / Neither is right, because linking words do nothing] | **Fiona is right, because the two words point in opposite directions** | Bring water because the trail is long (reason). The trail is long; therefore, bring water (result). |

## JUDGE IT, THEN WRITE IT (3 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| t4a_s0 | Set 1: Which piece supports its opinion better? [Fidel’s, because it has reasons, examples with facts, linking words, and a conclusion / Fiorella’s, because it is shorter / Fiorella’s, because it says best two times / Neither, because both are only feelings] | **Fidel’s, because it has reasons, examples with facts, linking words, and a conclusion** | Judge the support, not the place. Fidel proves each reason with an example. |
| t4b_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: How many of the linking words because, for example, also, and therefore does Fiorella use? (Type the number.) | **0** (also accepted: zero, none) | Fiorella uses none of them. Her sentences are not connected. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| t4c_s0 | Set 1: Find the mistake! Foster says, "Fiorella's opinion is wrong, because the Nature Center is better." What went wrong? [An opinion is not right or wrong. Fiorella's piece just needs better support. / The Nature Center is not real. / Fiorella did not give an opinion. / Nothing went wrong.] | **An opinion is not right or wrong. Fiorella's piece just needs better support.** | Ms. Fonda says an opinion is not right or wrong. The question is how well it is supported. |
| t4a_s1 | Set 2: Which is the best new FIRST sentence for Fiorella's piece? [I think our class should visit the North Carolina Arboretum because it has so much to explore. / The Arboretum is the best. / My cousin got a new red bike. / Therefore, it is really nice.] | **I think our class should visit the North Carolina Arboretum because it has so much to explore.** | This sentence gives the opinion clearly and adds a reason with because. |
| t4b_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: Finish Fiorella's revision: "For example, it has hiking trails. It ___ has a garden railway with model trains." | **also** | Also adds one more idea to the list of things to explore. |
| t4c_s1 | Set 2: Which sentence would make the best CONCLUSION for Fiorella's revised piece? [Therefore, the North Carolina Arboretum is a great choice for our field trip. / For example, it has trails. / It is really nice. / My cousin got a new red bike.] | **Therefore, the North Carolina Arboretum is a great choice for our field trip.** | A conclusion says the opinion again. Therefore signals that it is the conclusion. |
| t4a_s2 | Set 3: Which sentence should Fiorella CUT from her piece? [My cousin got a new red bike. / The Arboretum is the best. / It is really fun. / Everyone should go there.] | **My cousin got a new red bike.** | The bike sentence is off topic. It has nothing to do with the field trip. |
| t4b_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: Write the linking word that fits: "Fidel gave reasons and facts. ___, his piece will go on the front page." | **therefore** | Going on the front page is the result of his strong support, so use Therefore. |
| t4c_s2 | Set 3: Which explanation is correct? Fiona says, "Both writers could write strong pieces, because the support makes a piece strong, not the place." Foster says, "Only a piece about the Nature Center can be strong." [Fiona is right, because any opinion can be strong with good reasons and examples / Foster is right, because animals are better than gardens / Foster is right, because Fidel is older / Neither is right, because no opinion piece can be strong] | **Fiona is right, because any opinion can be strong with good reasons and examples** | With reasons, facts, linking words, and a conclusion, Fiorella's Arboretum piece can be strong too. |

## MATCH-UP ROUND (2 POINTS PER FIRST-TRY MATCH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| match_s0_1 | Set 1: Match Opinion | **what a writer thinks or believes** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s0_2 | Set 1: Match Reason | **tells why the writer thinks so** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s0_3 | Set 1: Match Example | **a fact or detail that proves a reason** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| match_s0_4 | Set 1: Match Conclusion | **the ending that says the opinion again** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s0_5 | Set 1: Match Linking word | **a word that connects ideas** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s1_1 | Set 2: Match because | **comes before a reason** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s1_2 | Set 2: Match therefore | **comes before a result or conclusion** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s1_3 | Set 2: Match for example | **comes before an example** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s1_4 | Set 2: Match also | **adds one more idea** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s1_5 | Set 2: Match first | **tells the first reason in order** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s2_1 | Set 3: Match Black bears and red wolves | **the Western North Carolina Nature Center** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s2_2 | Set 3: Match A bonsai collection | **the North Carolina Arboretum** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s2_3 | Set 3: Match The Blue Ridge Mountains | **the mountains around Asheville** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s2_4 | Set 3: Match The Mountain Kids Gazette | **a newspaper written by kids** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |
| match_s2_5 | Set 3: Match Ms. Fonda | **the newspaper's editor** | 2 points if matched on the first try. |

### FIX THE SENTENCE (5 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| fx1_s0 | Set 1: Fix the sentence. A name, a city, and a state need capital letters. fidel lives in asheville, north carolina. | **Fidel lives in Asheville, North Carolina.** | Fidel is a name, Asheville is a city, and North Carolina is a state. Each name starts with a capital letter. |
| fx2_s0 | Set 1: Fix the sentence. Add the comma that goes after a linking word at the start of a sentence. For example the Arboretum has hiking trails. | **For example, the Arboretum has hiking trails.** | When for example starts a sentence, put a comma after it. |
| fx1_s1 | Set 2: Fix the sentence. Add the comma that goes after a linking word at the start of a sentence. Therefore we should go to the Nature Center. | **Therefore, we should go to the Nature Center.** | When therefore starts a sentence, put a comma after it. |
| fx2_s1 | Set 2: Fix the sentence. Fix the one grammar mistake. The red wolves was almost gone. | **The red wolves were almost gone.** | Wolves means more than one, so use were, not was. |
| fx1_s2 | Set 3: Fix the sentence. The word I and the name of a place need capital letters. i think we should visit the north carolina arboretum. | **I think we should visit the North Carolina Arboretum.** | The word I is always a capital letter. North Carolina Arboretum is the name of a place. |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| fx2_s2 | Set 3: Fix the sentence. Add commas to separate the things in the list. The Nature Center has black bears river otters and red wolves. | **The Nature Center has black bears, river otters, and red wolves.** (also accepted: The Nature Center has black bears, river otters and red wolves.) | Use commas to separate three or more things in a list. |

## TYPE-IT CORRAL (4 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| ty1_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: Fidel and Fiorella sent their pieces to the Mountain Kids ___. | **Gazette** | The newspaper is called the Mountain Kids Gazette. |
| ty2_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: Bonsai trees are tiny trees growing in ___. | **pots** (also accepted: a pot) | The Arboretum has a bonsai collection of tiny trees growing in pots. |
| ty3_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: Two steps: 18 students and 3 grown-ups ride the bus. Each bus seat holds 2 people. How many seats do they need? (Type the number.) | **11** (also accepted: eleven, 11 seats) | First add: 18 plus 3 equals 21 people. Then 10 seats hold 20 people, and 1 more person needs a seat, so they need 11 seats. |
| ty1_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: Asheville is a city in the Blue Ridge ___. | **Mountains** | The newspaper page says Asheville is a city in the Blue Ridge Mountains. |
| ty2_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: Fidel's second reason is that we can learn how people help ___. | **animals** | Fidel writes, "Second, we can learn how people help animals." |
| ty3_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: Two steps: The Gazette has 4 pages, with 3 stories on each page. Two of the stories are opinion pieces. How many stories are NOT opinion pieces? (Type the number.) | **10** (also accepted: ten) | First multiply: 4 times 3 equals 12 stories. Then subtract: 12 minus 2 equals 10. |
| ty1_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: Fiorella's off-topic sentence is about her cousin's new red ___. | **bike** | She wrote, "My cousin got a new red bike," which has nothing to do with the field trip. |
| ty2_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: The North Carolina Arboretum is near the Blue Ridge ___. | **Parkway** | The newspaper page says the Arboretum is near the Blue Ridge Parkway. |
| ty3_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: Two steps: The editors got 9 opinion pieces on Monday and 7 on Tuesday. They printed 4. How many pieces were NOT printed? (Type the number.) | **12** (also accepted: twelve) | First add: 9 plus 7 equals 16. Then subtract: 16 minus 4 equals 12. |

## BOSS BATTLE: FRONT-PAGE SHOWDOWN (5 POINTS EACH)

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| b1_s0 | Set 1: Two steps: Which TWO linking words does Fidel use to start his first two reasons? [First and Second / Because and therefore / Also and for example / Therefore and also] | **First and Second** | Fidel starts paragraph 2 with First and paragraph 3 with Second. Time-order words help list reasons. |
| b2_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: Fidel writes that about 50 years ago, scientists could find only ___ red wolves to start a program to save them. (Type the number.) | **14** (also accepted: fourteen) | Fidel writes, "About 50 years ago, scientists could find only 14 red wolves to start a program to save them." |

| ID | Question | Answer | Why (explain to student) |
|---|---|---|---|
| b3_s0 | Set 1: Find the mistake! Fiona says, “The red wolf numbers are Fidel’s opinion.” What went wrong? [The numbers are facts. Fidel uses them as an example to support his reason. / There are no numbers in the piece. / Numbers are always opinions. / Nothing went wrong.] | **The numbers are facts. Fidel uses them as an example to support his reason.** | Facts can be checked. Fidel uses this fact to prove his reason. |
| b4_s0 | Set 1: Type your answer: Fidel ends his piece with, “Let’s go ___!” | **wild** | His last line is, “Let’s go wild!” |
| b1_s1 | Set 2: Which revision makes Fiorella’s reason STRONGER? [It is fun because we can hike on trails and see a garden railway with model trains. / It is really, really fun. / It is fun. I like fun. / It is fun, and my cousin has a bike.] | **It is fun because we can hike on trails and see a garden railway with model trains.** | The strong revision tells WHY it is fun and gives examples. The others only repeat a feeling or go off topic. |
| b2_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: Fidel writes, “The Nature Center is right here in Asheville, ___ the bus ride would be short.” Type the missing word. | **so** | So comes before the effect: the bus ride would be short. |
| b3_s1 | Set 2: Which explanation is correct? Fiona says, “Fidel’s Also paragraph adds a third reason.” Foster says, “Fidel’s Also paragraph is his conclusion.” [Fiona is right, because also adds one more idea, and the conclusion starts with Therefore / Foster is right, because also ends a piece / Foster is right, because it is the shortest paragraph / Neither is right, because Fidel has no Also paragraph] | **Fiona is right, because also adds one more idea, and the conclusion starts with Therefore** | Also adds the short bus ride as a third reason. Therefore starts the conclusion. |
| b4_s1 | Set 2: Type your answer: The linking word ___ tells the reader that the conclusion is coming. | **therefore** | Ms. Fonda says: Therefore tells the reader that the conclusion is coming. |
| b1_s2 | Set 3: Which piece should Forrest and Fiona print on the front page, and why? [Fidel’s, because it supports its opinion with reasons, facts, and linking words / Fiorella’s, because she says it is the best place ever / Fiorella’s, because her cousin has a bike / Fidel’s, because the Nature Center is always the right answer] | **Fidel’s, because it supports its opinion with reasons, facts, and linking words** | The editors print the piece with the best support. The place is not what decides it. |
| b2_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: Two steps: The class voted. 11 kids picked the Nature Center, 8 picked the Arboretum, and 3 did not vote. How many kids are in the class? (Type the number.) | **22** (also accepted: twenty-two, twenty two) | Add all three groups: 11 plus 8 equals 19, and 19 plus 3 equals 22. |
| b3_s2 | Set 3: Find the mistake! Foster starts his piece with: “Also, the Arboretum has trails.” What went wrong? [Also adds one more idea, so it cannot come first, before any idea has been given. / Trails are not real. / Every piece must start with also. / Nothing went wrong.] | **Also adds one more idea, so it cannot come first, before any idea has been given.** | A piece should start with the opinion, like “I think our class should visit the Arboretum.” |
| b4_s2 | Set 3: Type your answer: In “For example, the Nature Center has black bears,” the mark after For example is a ___. | **comma** (also accepted: a comma) | Put a comma after a linking word like for example when it starts a sentence. |

# Pre & Post sheet answer guide

*Many items are open-ended. Grade for genuine understanding and complete sentences, not exact wording. Sheet: grade3/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G3W27.pdf.*

### PRE-LESSON WARM-UP

| # | Prompt | Model answer / grading note |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Review: central message of Momotarō as a full sentence | Model: When we share and work together, we can do hard things that no one could do alone. |
| 2 | I think the best place for a class field trip is ... | Answers vary. Accept any opinion that names a place. |
| 3 | One reason for your opinion, starting with because | Answers vary. Look for a reason that tells WHY (for example: because we can see real animals), not only a feeling. |
| 4 | Circle the feeling, not a reason | (b) I like it a lot. |
| 5 | Have you read a newspaper or magazine for kids? What would you write about? | Answers vary. |

### POST-LESSON CHALLENGE

| # | Prompt | Model answer / grading note |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Linking words: We should go to the Nature Center ___ it is close by. ___, it has red wolves. | because; For example |
| 2 | Forrest: I think we should visit the Arboretum. It is really nice. My dog likes bones. | Either weak sentence: “It is really nice” is only a feeling (it does not tell why and has no example), or “My dog likes bones” is off topic and should be cut. |
| 3 | 14 voted for the Nature Center and 9 for the Arboretum | Step 1: 14 + 9 = 23 voted in all. Step 2: 14 − 9 = 5 more chose the Nature Center. |
| 4 | Opinion piece: Should kids get more time outside each day? | Answers vary. Check for all four parts: an opinion (I think ...), a reason with because, an example with For example, and a conclusion with Therefore (with commas after For example and Therefore). |

### ★ CHALLENGE

| # | Prompt | Model answer / grading note |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Add a second reason that starts with Also | Answers vary. The sentence starts with Also, gives a new on-topic reason, and is not just a feeling. |